Bellevue School District AI Handbook: Data and Student Privacy Passages

Excerpted verbatim from *Bellevue School District AI Handbook (Bellevue School District, Washington; last updated September 2026)*. Page numbers match the document's own page numbering. Ellipses (…) mark omitted text. One passage from a two-column table is transcribed from the extracted page text and marked [graphic].

Our District Guiding Principles (excerpt)

Source: page 3

4. Private & Secure by Design: We protect student and staff data by following privacy laws, security standards, and district guidelines when using AI tools.

Strategic Alignment (excerpt)

Source: page 4

- Sustainable and responsible operations, balancing innovation with fiscal responsibility, privacy, and environmental considerations

Privacy

Source: pages 7–8

How the District Uses AI Safely and Responsibly

The district may use artificial intelligence tools to support learning, communication, and day-to-day operations. When we do, protecting student and staff information is a top priority. Below is a clear explanation of how we safeguard data and respect privacy.

Protecting Student and Staff Information

When AI tools are used, the district takes steps to protect students, staff, and district information from misuse, leaks, or unauthorized access. Any use of AI must follow existing district technology and privacy rules, as well as federal and state privacy laws, including laws that protect student education records.

Using Only the Information That Is Necessary

We limit the amount of information shared with AI tools.

- Staff are encouraged to use summaries or examples instead of full student records.
- Whenever possible, information is removed, changed, or made anonymous before it is used.
- AI tools should be given only what is needed to complete a task, nothing more.

Keeping AI Tools Secure

AI tools are not connected to school systems like email, grading systems, or payroll unless the district’s IT department has approved it. This helps reduce the risk of data breaches or account compromise. All AI use must meet the district’s cybersecurity and technology use standards.

Protecting Personal Information

Personal information must always be handled carefully when using AI tools. Personal information includes things like:

- Student names, ID numbers, or photos
- Grades, attendance, or discipline records
- Health or special education information
- Staff personnel records

This type of information is not entered into public or consumer AI tools unless the district has approved it. Even small pieces of information can sometimes identify a person when combined with other details, so care is taken to avoid that.

NOTE: Microsoft Copilot Chat is the only district-approved AI tool for use with personal, confidential, or private information, and staff must not enter this type of information into any other AI tool.

Following Privacy Laws (FERPA)

All uses of AI follow the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) and other privacy laws.

- Student education records are only shared when legally allowed—such as with family permission or for a valid educational reason.
- If a vendor's AI system uses student data, the vendor must follow strict rules and can only use that data for approved educational purposes under district control.

Being Transparent with Families

We believe trust comes from openness.

- The district will clearly explain when AI tools are used, why they are used, and how information is protected.

Resources:

- 2022P: Electronic Resources - Student Acceptable Use of District Network
- 6800.2P: Acceptable Use
- FAMILY EDUCATIONAL RIGHTS AND PRIVACY

Governance and Oversight: Roles and Responsibilities (excerpt)

Source: page 9

Staff: Use only district-approved AI tools; Follow district expectations for privacy, safety, and data protection; Report concerns, risks, or misuse when identified

Data Governance and Systems

Source: page 9

Data governance includes key areas such as acceptable use, student records and privacy, information security, records management, and incident response. These areas are covered by other resources:

- 2022P: Electronic Resources - Student Acceptable Use of District Network
- 6800.2P: Acceptable Use

- 3231P: Student Records
- FAMILY EDUCATIONAL RIGHTS AND PRIVACY

Overview of AI Tools in Use

Source: page 9

Bellevue School District uses a set of approved AI tools that have been reviewed for privacy, security, educational or operational value, and alignment with district values, and that include safeguards for student and staff data. Approved tools include Magic School, Colleague AI and Microsoft Copilot. Microsoft Copilot Chat is the only district-approved AI tool for use with personal, confidential, or private information, and staff must not enter this type of information into any other AI tool.

Staff should not use personal or unapproved AI tools for school or district business unless explicitly authorized.

Procurement and Vendor Requirements

Source: page 10

All AI tools must follow district procurement and vendor review processes.

Before approval, vendors must meet district privacy, security, and legal requirements, including signing data privacy agreements and clearly explaining how district data is collected, stored, deleted, and protected. Vendors may not use district data to train AI models unless explicitly authorized by the district.

AI Tool Evaluation and Approval Process

- The tool is reviewed for data protection, legal compliance, security, educational or operational value, and equity and accessibility considerations.

Approval is required before an AI tool is used with students or district data.

Monitoring and Re-evaluating AI Tools

Approved AI tools are monitored over time for vendor or policy changes, reported concerns, and continued alignment with district expectations. If concerns arise or a tool is no longer appropriate for district use, it may be restricted, re-evaluated, paused, or removed, and the district will communicate expectations to staff, address data retention or deletion, and update the approved tools list.

Risks and Responsibilities in Teaching & Learning (excerpt)

Source: page 12

Data Privacy: Personally identifiable student information must never be entered into tools that have not been reviewed and approved by BSD.

Educator Use of AI (excerpt)

Source: pages 15–16 [graphic]

Unhelpful Educator Uses

- [graphic] Entering student PII (personally identifiable information) into non-approved AI tools

Educators are responsible for:

- Maintaining student privacy

Using AI Productively in Assessment & Feedback (excerpt)

Source: page 16

Data pattern review: Summarizing aggregate (non-PII) assessment data to support instructional planning.